

pitchPulse

Live prediction markets for IPL matches

A detailed review of UI, missing features, and how to make the experience less daunting for first-time users. Prepared for internal use.

SCOPE

9 screens · desktop + mobile ·
light + dark

METHOD

Registered fresh user, placed
real orders, inspected DB &
API

BENCHMARKS

Polymarket · Kalshi · Manifold
Markets

Executive summary

The trading engine and visual polish are **80% of a Polymarket-clone for cricket**. The missing 20% is all about reducing the distance between watching a match on TV and placing a confident bet.

Top 5 recommendations, ranked by impact

1 Add a live-match context header

Users have no link between the app and the game on their TV. Handover spec already calls for this.

2 Hide drafts & cancelled contracts from non-admins

Regular users currently see admin scratch work (VERIFY 3, TEST: ...) on the "All" tab. The single worst UX issue found.

3 Replace the 1-99 price slider with a "market order" default

The slider is the most intimidating element in the app. The home cards already nail this pattern — just extend it to the contract detail page.

4 Switch the home feed to a 2/3-column grid on desktop

Currently a 672px column sits on a 1440px screen. Roughly half the desktop width is wasted whitespace.

5 Add a "My bets" tab and resolution notifications

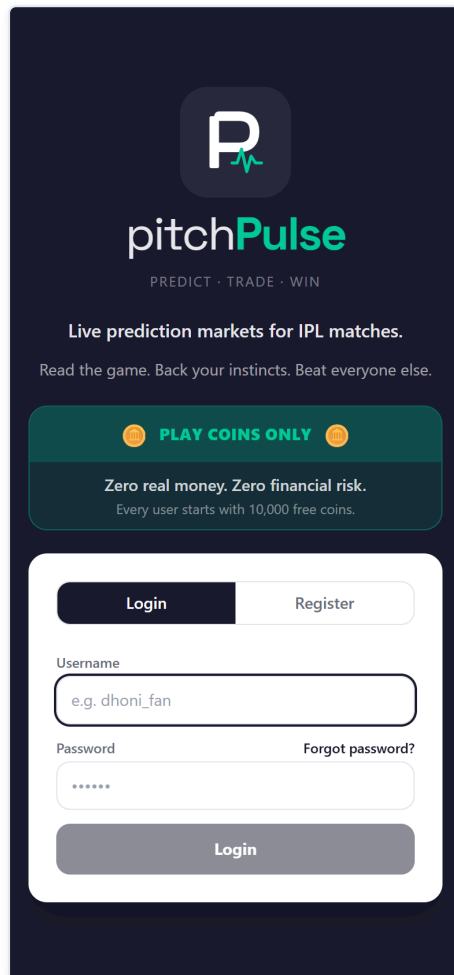
The dopamine loop is missing. Friends won't re-check Portfolio every over — show them when their bet settles.

5 CONFIRMED BUGS

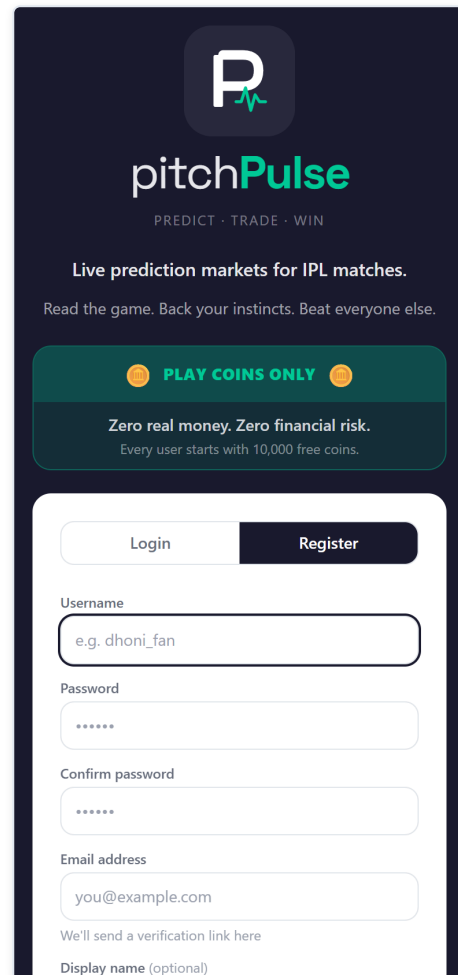
Duplicate React key on Home.jsx · OnboardingTour crashes on rapid Next-click · `/api/contracts` exposes drafts + cancelled to users · Chart x-axis shows "09:28" repeated on sparse data · Balance clipped on mobile navbar for 4+ digit values.

1 · UI: what I saw, what to change

1.1 Login & Register — strong first impression



Login screen on mobile.



Register form.

Works well

- **"PLAY COINS ONLY · Zero real money"** banner defuses the only real worry a new user has — best piece of copy in the whole app.
- Logo + "PREDICT · TRADE · WIN" tagline is clean and on-brand.
- Placeholder e.g. dhoni_fan is nicely on-theme.

Change

- **Email verification dead-ends users** in a private-friends context. The "Check your email" screen has no way out if the email is mistyped. Since this is invites-only, drop verification entirely and replace with an invite-code gate (already planned for deployment in the handover).

- Password field has no show/hide toggle and no strength hint.

1.2 Onboarding tour — best feature of the app, but fragile

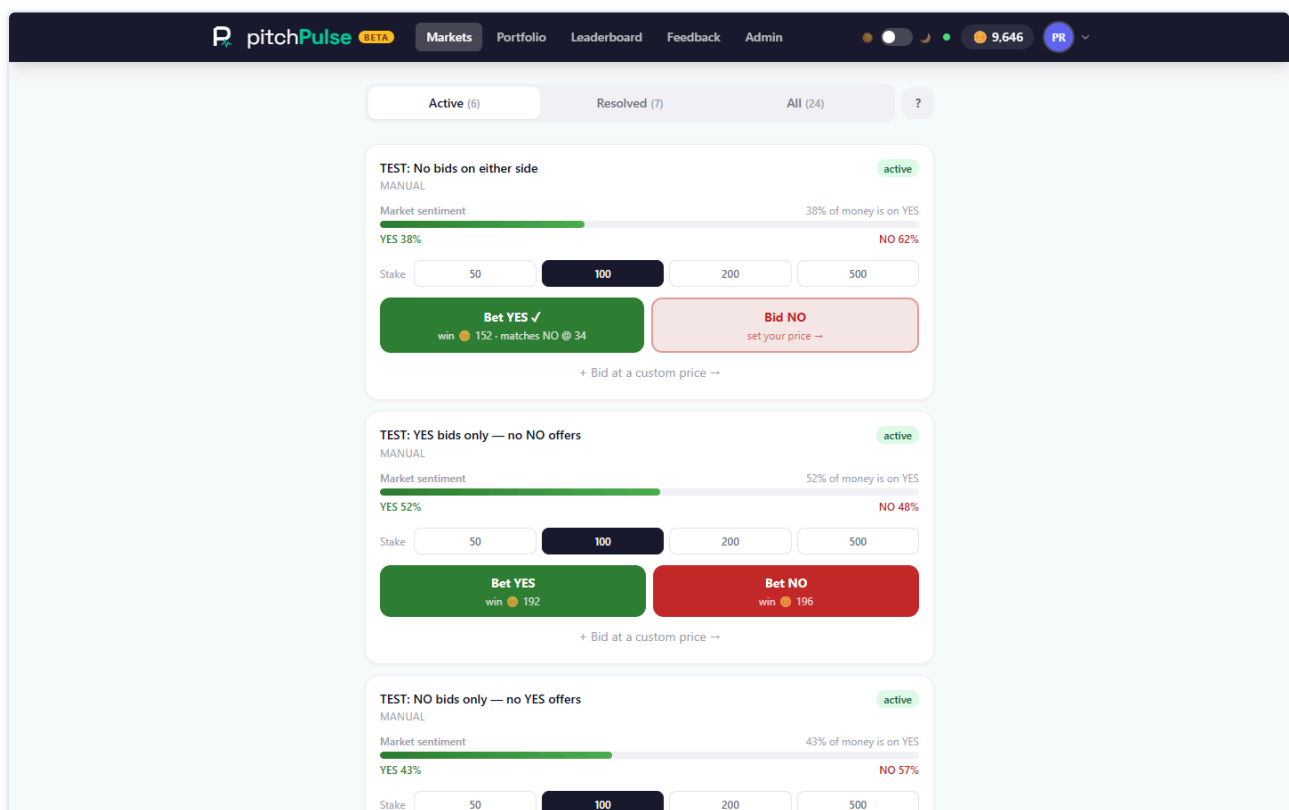
Works well

- Tour-during-demo-data pattern is sophisticated: two dummy cards show while real data loads in the background.
- Copy is calibrated. *"Always player vs player, never the house"* is the exact reassurance a new user needs.

Change

- **BUG: Tour crashes on rapid Next-clicks.** A React error boundary fires and the whole page goes blank. See `OnboardingTour.jsx:131`.
- The "Welcome" card is generic. Consider a **1-frame animated GIF of a price bar moving** — the single most aha-moment of prediction markets.
- Add a visible **"Replay tutorial"** link in the footer. The "?" top-right button is easy to miss.
- End the tour on the simplest live market, not on the feed top (which was "VERIFY 3: post-ws-fix smoke test" in my session).

1.3 Home feed — biggest UI opportunity on the whole app

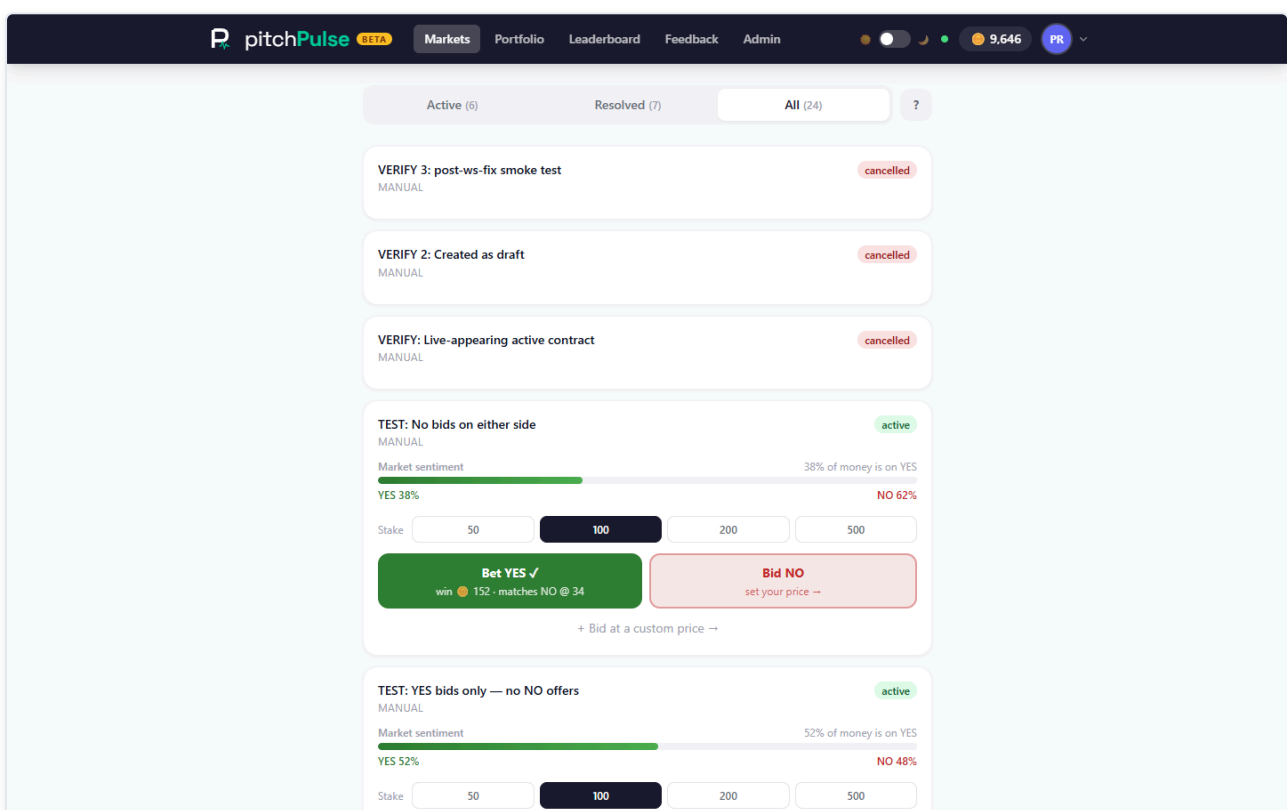


Desktop home — a 672 px column sitting on a 1440 px screen. Roughly half the viewport is empty.

Change — layout

- On md+ breakpoints, switch to a 2-column grid. On lg+, 3-column. Tailwind: `grid md:grid-cols-2 lg:grid-cols-3 gap-4`.
- **Add a live-match context strip** at the top of the feed (handover spec explicitly asks for this and it is missing): "*GT vs KKR · 127/4 (14.2) · RR 9.0*".
- Add a **"My bets" tab**. The handover specifies Active / Resolved / *My bets*. Currently only Active / Resolved / All.

The worst issue — drafts & test data shown to regular users



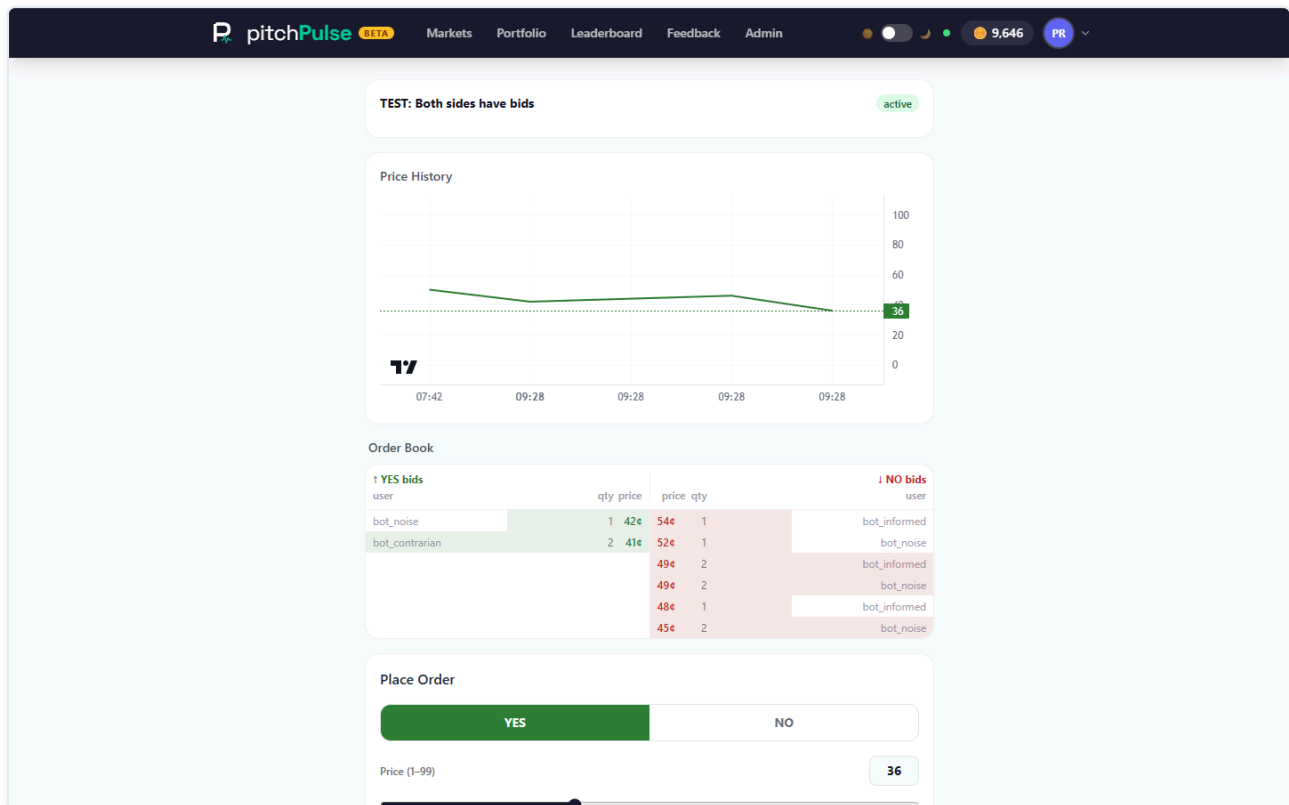
The "All" tab greets users with "VERIFY 3: post-ws-fix smoke test" and other dev leftovers.

GET `/api/contracts` in `server/routes/contracts.js:23` returns every contract regardless of status or user role. Regular users see admin drafts and cancelled test contracts at the top of their feed.

FIX

Add a WHERE clause: non-admins should only see status `IN ('active', 'resolved')`. Also, seed data named "TEST: ..." should be cleaned before the first real match.

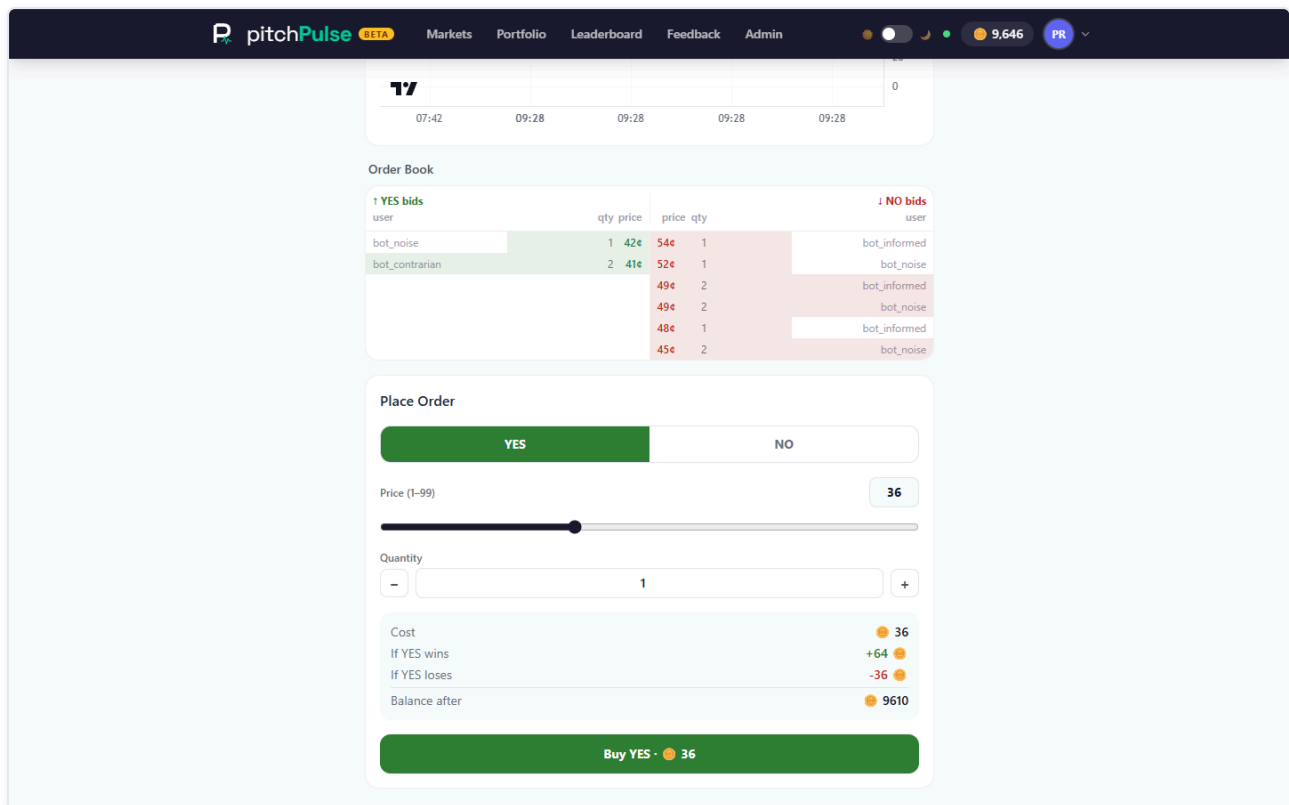
1.4 Contract detail — functional, but daunting



Contract detail — chart, order book, and Place Order stacked. Price slider is the most intimidating UI in the app.

Problems

- **Chart X-axis is broken** — timestamps show "09:28" four times in a row. Lightweight-charts tick formatter not handling sparse data.
- The **giant current-probability headline** (Polymarket-style "68% YES", 48-72 px) is missing. Current price is buried in the chart's right gutter.
- The **price slider (1-99)** is the most intimidating element in the whole app. A casual user does not know what "42¢" means.
- **Order book reveals usernames.** Manifold and Kalshi both anonymize. Add a "Show traders" toggle — hidden by default.
- **No time-remaining.** Contracts have an over_number but nothing says "expires at end of over 8" or "25 minutes remaining".

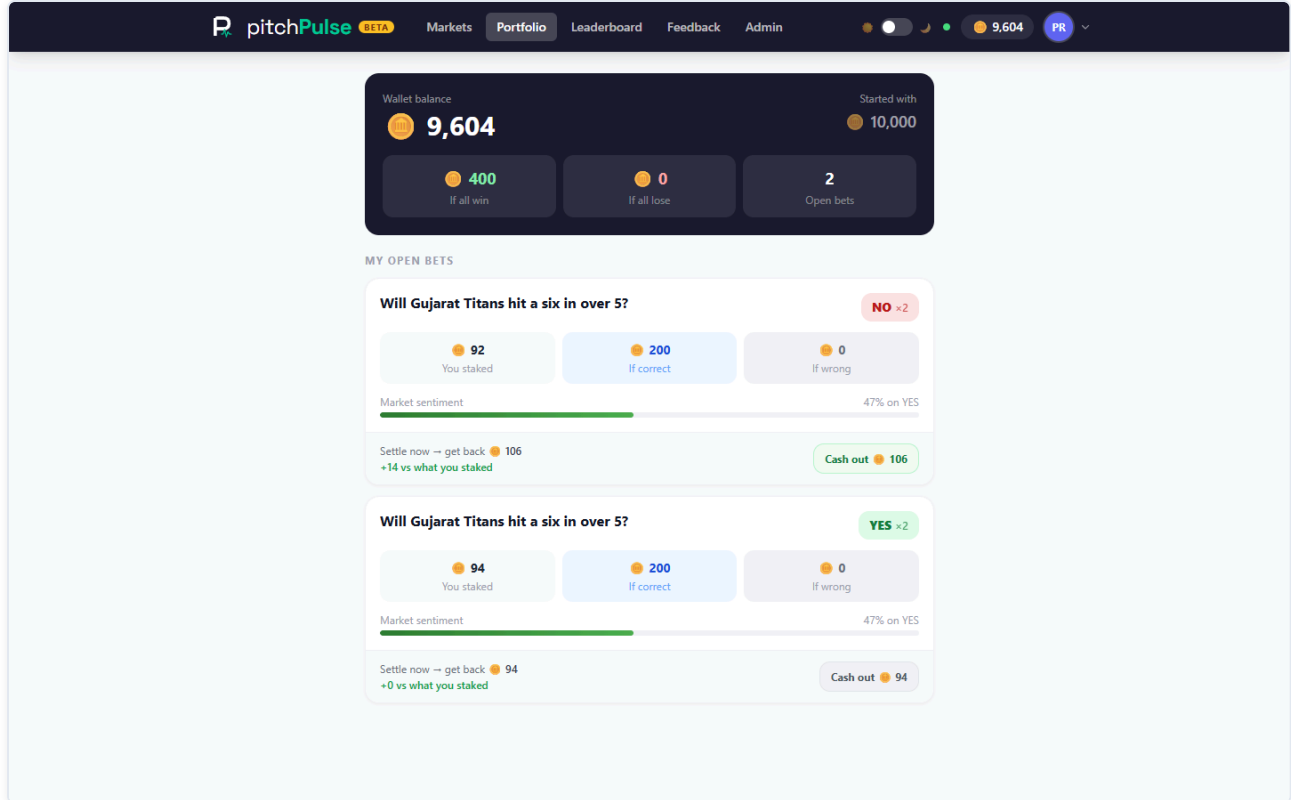


Place Order panel — slider + 1-99 price + quantity is trader-style UX on a casual-betting app.

THE BIGGEST SINGLE WIN

Default the Place Order panel to a "Market" mode with just big **YES / NO** buttons and stake presets (50 / 100 / 200 / custom) — the same pattern the home cards already use. Hide the price slider behind an "Advanced — set your own price" accordion.

1.5 Portfolio — best dark-mode screen



Portfolio — the "Cash out 🪙 112" button is a genuinely smart feature Polymarket only added recently.

Works well

- Summary card (balance, if-all-win, if-all-lose, open bets) is excellent.
- "Settle now — get back 🟡 112 / +20 vs what you staked" with a Cash out button is standout UX.

Change

- Add a small graphical risk bar: "Best case +800 / Worst case -400".
- No filter / sort for open bets. Needed once a user has 10+ positions.
- No resolved-positions history when empty. Users will want "I bought @ 32, sold @ 56".

1.6 Leaderboard — functional but bland

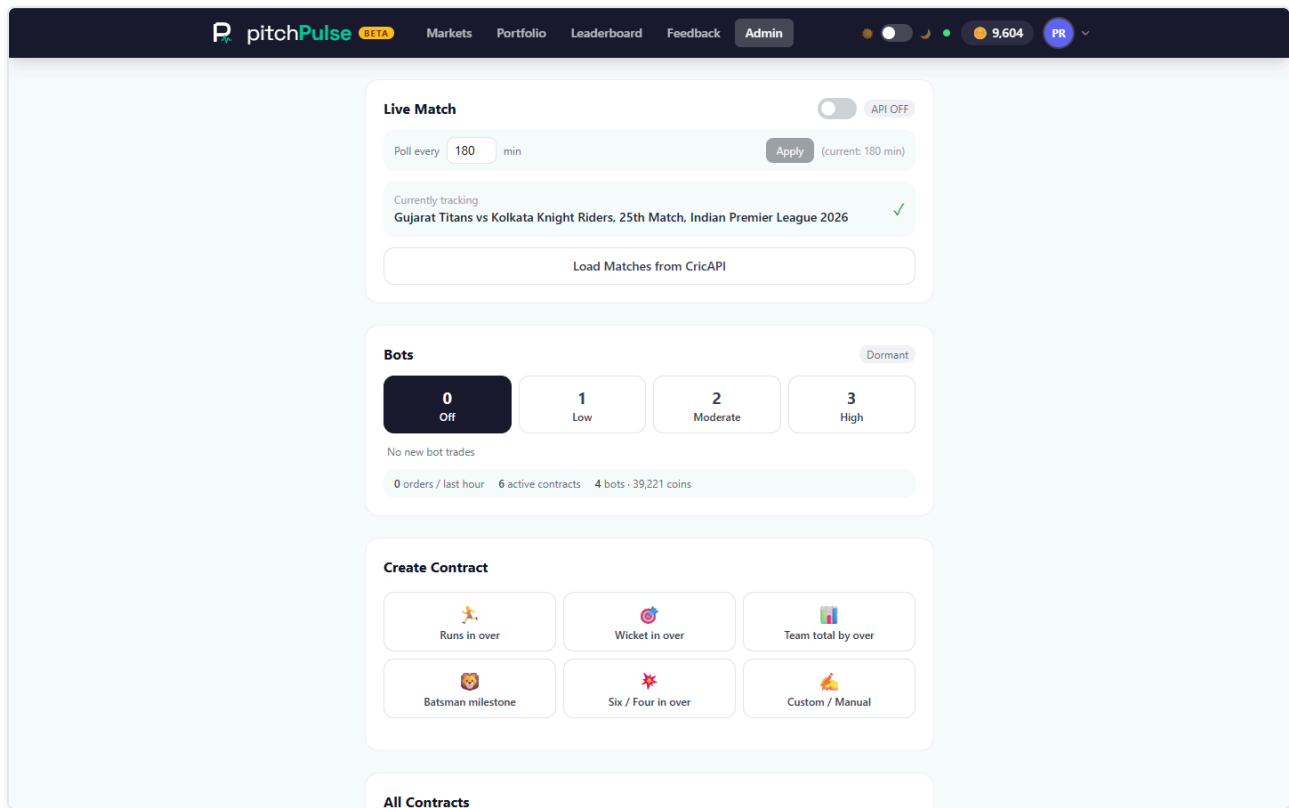
Leaderboard		
Starting balance: 🟡 10,000		
alice	0 trades	🟡 10,000 +0
admin	0 trades	🟡 10,000 +0
testuser1	0 trades	🟡 10,000 +0
4 testuser2	0 trades	🟡 10,000 +0
5 testuser3	0 trades	🟡 10,000 +0
6 golgames	0 trades	🟡 10,000 +0
7 golgames1	0 trades	🟡 10,000 +0
8 golgames2	0 trades	🟡 10,000 +0
9 golpolmol	0 trades	🟡 10,000 +0
10 aa	0 trades	🟡 10,000 +0
11 tourtest	0 trades	🟡 10,000 +0
sqtest		🟡 10,000

Leaderboard — everyone at 10,000 on a fresh install. Test users clutter the board.

Change

- Add a "**P&L today**" column so tied balances sort by most-active.
- Bot users are correctly excluded ✓ — but test users (testuser1, tourtest, sqtest, golgames1-2, aa) clutter the board. Add an `is_test` flag.
- Add a period filter: **Today / This match / All-time** (like Manifold).
- Add avatars. At minimum let users pick an emoji.

1.7 Admin panel — best PM-built-it screen in the app



Admin top — bot intensity dial and CricAPI match tracking are well done.

Works well

- Tile-based contract-type picker with live preview sentence.
- Bot intensity dial (0-3) is a thoughtful addition for dev/testing.
- Two-step "confirm → YES / NO" resolve modal is safer than Polymarket's one-click.

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BETA

Markets

Portfolio

Leaderboard

Feedback

Admin

9,604

PR

011

Low

Moderate

High

No new bot trades

0 orders / last hour6 active contracts4 bots - 39,221 coins

Create Contract

Runs in over

Wicket in over

Team total by over

Batsman milestone

Six / Four in over

Custom / Manual

Select...

Over number

Select...

Runs threshold

Resolve mode

Manual

Publish as

Active now

PREVIEW

Will ... score >= N runs in over N?

Create Contract

All Contracts

VERIFY 3: post-ws-fix smoke test

cancelled

manual - manual - 50€

Contract builder — field labels are missing.

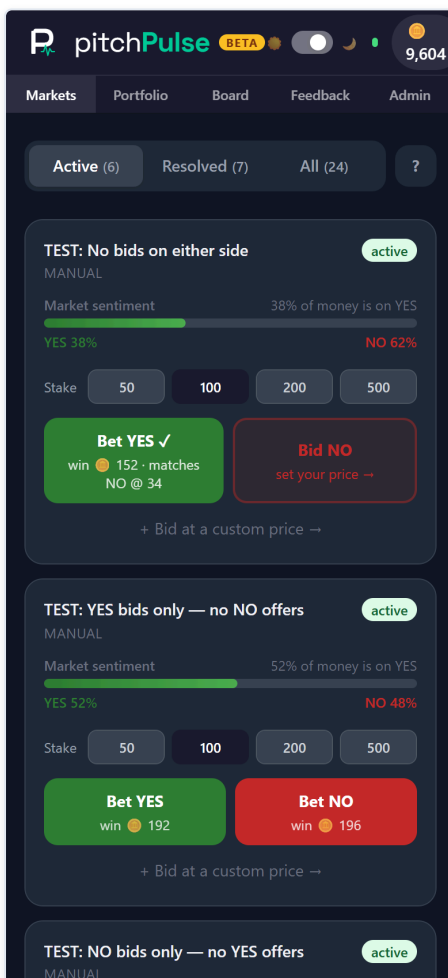
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Page 9

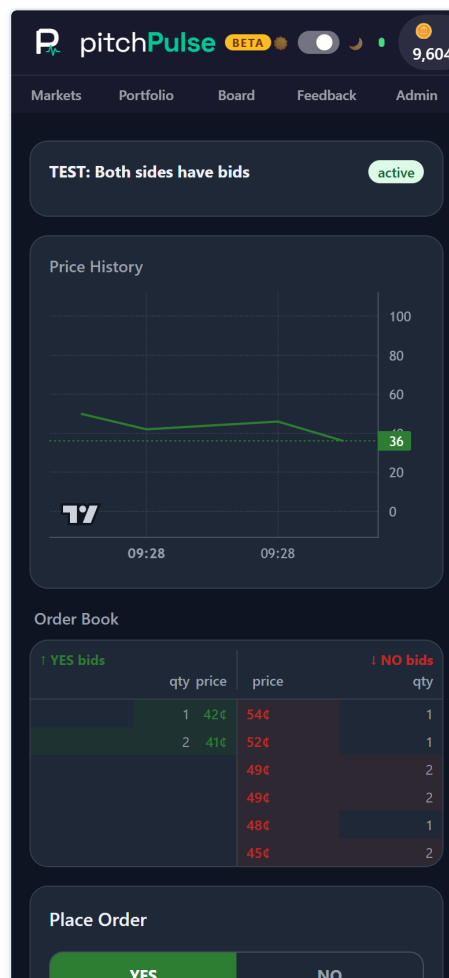
Change

- **Builder fields have placeholder-only labels** (Select..., Over number). During a live match the admin will mis-fill. Add visible labels above each field.
- **"All Contracts" list has no filter**: 24 rows in one scroll mixing active/draft/cancelled/resolved. Add status filter tabs.
- **No position count per contract** (handover: "Live view of how many users hold positions on each contract"). Admin cannot distinguish a hot market from a dead one.
- **No "Duplicate" button**. Same contract pattern repeats for every over × every team — admin will retype 20 times per match.

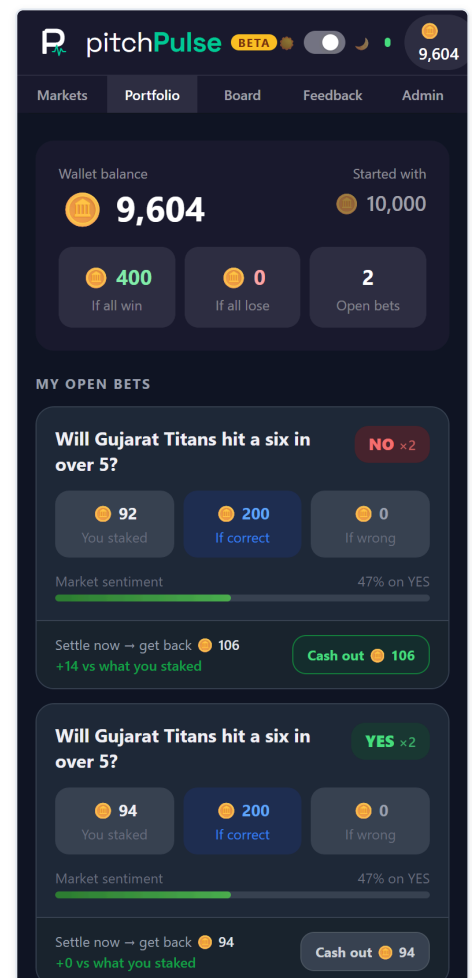
1.8 Mobile — small fit issues



Home mobile.



Contract mobile.

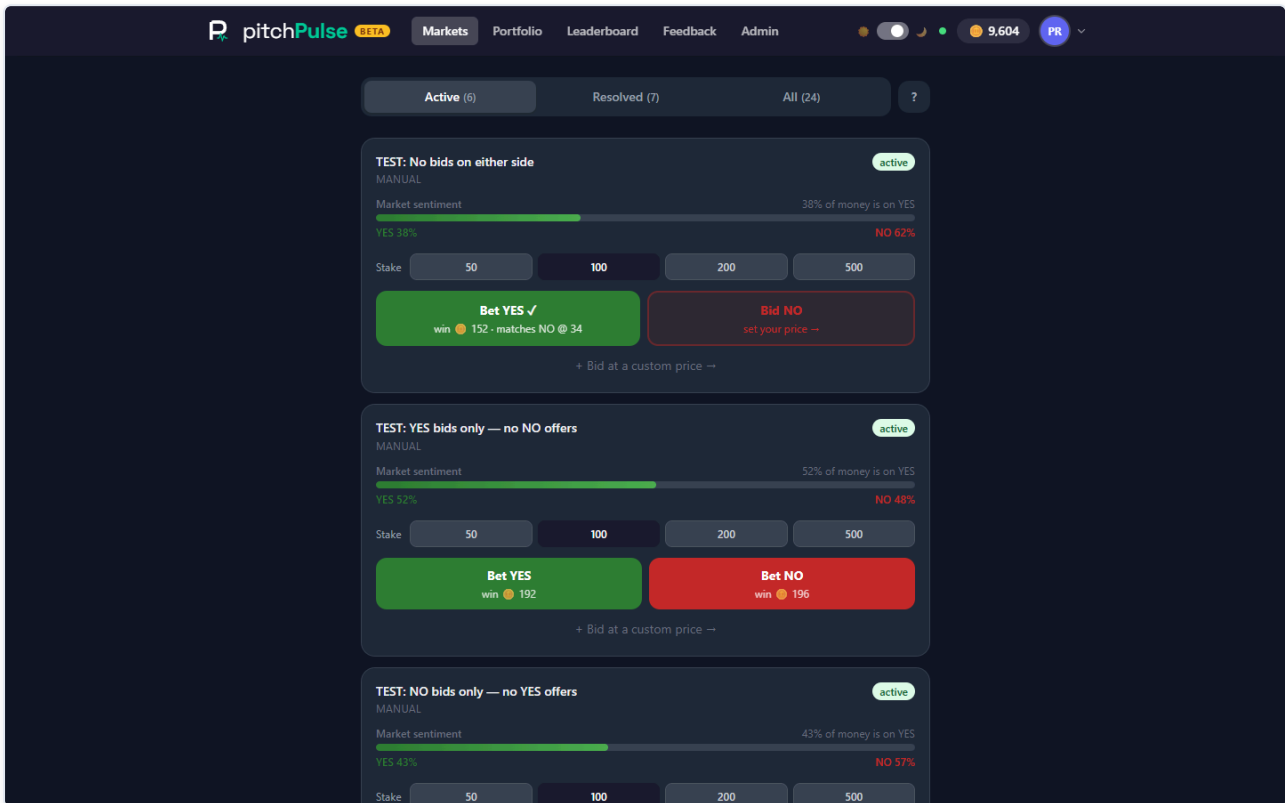


Portfolio mobile.

- Balance (9,646) clips to "9,64..." on 375 px widths because of the avatar. Shrink the avatar or truncate the label.

- "Leaderboard" abbreviated to **"Board"** on mobile is cryptic. Consider an icon-only bottom nav — what Polymarket mobile does.

1.9 Dark mode — well executed



Dark mode home — I would actually default to this for a cricket-night app.

- Detect prefers-color-scheme on first load. Users watching a match at night will open the app in bright white, which is jarring.

2 · Missing basic features

Items 1-5 are the fastest wins. 6-12 are meaningful. 13+ can wait for post-launch.

#	Feature	Impact	Effort
1	Live match header on Home (score, over, run-rate)	Critical	Low
2	Hide drafts & cancelled from non-admins	Critical	Trivial
3	Time-remaining on contract card	High	Low
4	"My bets" tab on Home (handover spec)	High	Low
5	Notifications when your bet resolves	High	Medium
6	Market-order / "fill at best price" on contract detail	High	Low
7	Contract-card volume + trader count	Med	Low
8	Push / desktop notifications on settlement	Med	Medium
9	Search on Home feed	Med	Low
10	Comments / group chat per market	Med	High
11	Share-a-bet bragging link	Med	Medium
12	Invite-code register (handover deferred)	Med	Low
13	Match selector (currently env-var-only)	Low	Medium
14	Password reset flow verification	Low	—
15	Account settings page	Low	Medium
16	Avatars / emoji profiles	Low	Low
17	Trade history log per user	Low	Medium

3 · Reducing daunting-ness

The app is close to approachable, but has three intimidation points for a non-finance friend joining for the first time.

3.1 Terminology

- Words like *Order book*, *bids*, *asks*, *price* are trading terms. The home feed smartly uses "Stake 🏠 50 / Bet YES / win 🏠 154" instead.
- **Extend that vocabulary to the contract detail page.** Say *Stake* not *Cost*, *if you win you get back* not *If YES wins*, *predict price* not *Price (1-99)*.
- Add a ? tooltip next to every trading term on first visit.

3.2 Visual complexity

- The contract detail page stacks 4 dense components vertically: title, chart, order book, trade panel. On a phone this is a lot of scrolling.
- **Collapse the order book** by default behind "Show order book (12 bids)".
- Replace the price slider with **stake presets** (50 / 100 / 200 / 500 / custom) + market-price-only by default.

3.3 Emotional framing

- Show "play money" status on **every page header**, not just login. A tiny 🏠 *Play Coins* pill in the navbar reinforces "you cannot actually lose anything".
- **Resolved-position celebration.** When a bet resolves in your favor, show a one-time confetti toast. This is what makes Manifold addictive. Currently the only feedback is your balance going up silently.
- Seed the feed with an "easy" contract on match start — e.g. "Will the toss be won by Team A?" — that resolves in 60 seconds. Gives new users a confidence-building first bet before the in-match ones start.

3.4 Onboarding upgrade

- Tour is good — add a **"Practice mode"** card that lets users place a fake bet on the demo contract and see it fill, before they touch their real balance.
- End the tour on the simplest active market, not the feed top.

4 · Confirmed bugs

Bug 1 · Duplicate React key 22 on Home.jsx

Console shows "Encountered two children with the same key". Likely caused by the `contract_updated` WebSocket event re-adding a contract that's already in state — `Home.jsx:69-75` uses an `exists` check, but the initial load and a burst WS event can race.

Bug 2 · OnboardingTour crashes on rapid clicking

React error boundary triggered after a few Next clicks. Page goes blank. See `OnboardingTour.jsx:131`.

Bug 3 · `/api/contracts` exposes drafts & cancelled to non-admins

Backend `contracts.js:23-34` has no role-based filter. Users see admin scratch work on the "All" tab.

Bug 4 · Chart x-axis formatting

Timestamps show "09:28" repeated 4× when price history is sparse. `Lightweight-charts` tick formatter is not handling low-granularity data well. `PriceChart.jsx` is worth a look.

Bug 5 · Mobile navbar balance clipping

At 375 px viewport, balances with 4+ digits clip to "9,64..." because the avatar occupies the rest of the row.

Bottom line

*"The trading engine and visual polish are 80% of a Polymarket-clone for cricket. The missing 20% is all about reducing the distance between **watching a match on TV** and **placing a confident bet** — a live score header, a My-bets tab, a market-order default, and hiding draft / test data from users will move this from impressive prototype to I'll text my WhatsApp group to join tonight."*

END OF REPORT